2025 G7 Kananaskis Summit Final Compliance Report

18 June 2025 to 1 June 2026

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"We have meanwhile set up a process and there are also independent institutions monitoring which objectives of our G7 meetings we actually achieve. When it comes to these goals we have a compliance rate of about 80%, according to the University of Toronto. Germany, with its 87%, comes off pretty well. That means that next year too, under the Japanese G7 presidency, we are going to check where we stand in comparison to what we have discussed with each other now. So a lot of what we have resolved to do here together is something that we are going to have to work very hard at over the next few months. But I think that it has become apparent that we, as the G7, want to assume responsibility far beyond the prosperity in our own countries. That's why today's outreach meetings, that is the meetings with our guests, were also of great importance."

Chancellor Angela Merkel, Schloss Elmau, 8 June 2015

G7 summits are a moment for people to judge whether aspirational intent is met by concrete commitments. The G7 Research Group provides a report card on the implementation of G7 and G20 commitments. It is a good moment for the public to interact with leaders and say, you took a leadership position on these issues — a year later, or three years later, what have you accomplished?

Achim Steiner, Administrator, United Nations Development Programme,
in *G7 Canada: The 2018 Charlevoix Summit*

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4. Digital Economy: Artificial Intelligence for Small and Medium-Sized Enterprises

"We commit to … sustain investments in AI [artificial intelligence] adoption programs for SMEs [small and medium-sized enterprises], including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure."

G7 Leaders' Statement on AI for Prosperity

Assessment

	No Compliance	Partial Compliance	Full Compliance
Canada			+1
France			+1
Germany			+1
Italy			+1
Japan		0	
United Kingdom			+1
United States		0	
European Union			+1
Average		+0.75 (88%)	

Background

The adoption of artificial intelligence (AI) by small to medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) has been a fairly recent concern of the G7, particularly as AI capabilities have surged over the past decade and transformed global markets. Although early G7 discussions on AI focused on governance frameworks, research guidelines, and codes of conduct, more recent commitments have recognized that SMEs face distinct challenges in adopting these technologies. Unlike larger firms, SMEs often lack the financial resources, advanced computing infrastructure, and specialized expertise required to integrate AI effectively into their operations. They also struggle with workforce training and consumer trust, both of which are essential for deploying AI responsibly. As a result, accessibility and readiness have emerged as critical priorities: without targeted support, SMEs risk being left behind in the digital economy, widening competitiveness gaps across industries. The G7 Industry, Technology and Digital Ministers' Meeting in 2024 explicitly acknowledged these challenges, affirming the importance of training and workforce development to increase awareness and skills, and promoting technical collaboration and voluntary knowledge exchanges to foster competitiveness and level the playing field. Ministers also endorsed the development of a report analyzing the driving factors and challenges of AI adoption among SMEs, with policy options to promote safe, secure, and trustworthy integration while respecting intellectual property.[902] This was also seen at the 2025 Kananaskis Summit, where G7 members launched the AI Adoption Roadmap This roadmap provides "clear, actionable pathways for companies to adopt AI and scale their businesses," committing to commercialization support, cross-sector collaboration, practical use cases, AI literacy programs, talent exchanges, and trust-building measures.[903] Examples of G7 governance on this subject follow.

At the 2012 Camp David Summit, the G8 leaders responded to requests from transitioning economies by committing to support job creation through targeted assistance for SMEs.[904] G7 leaders pledged to strengthen enabling environments through bilateral and multilateral cooperation.

[902]Ministerial Meeting on Technology and Digital: G7 Joint Statement, G7 Information Centre (Toronto) 15 October 2025. Access Date: 18 November 2025. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/ict/241015-joint-statement.html
[903] G7 Leaders' Statement on AI for Prosperity (Kananaskis), G7 Information Centre (Toronto) 17 June 2025. Access Date: 18 November 2025. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/summit/2025kananaskis/250617-ai.html
[904] Fact Sheet: G8 Action on the Deauville Partnership with Arab Countries in Transition (Camp David) 19 May 2012. Access Date: 5 October 2025. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/summit/2012campdavid/g8-transition-factsheet.html

At the 2016 Ise-Shima Summit, the Information and Communication Technology (ICT) Ministers' Meeting marked the first time that the G7 leaders recognized the need for AI development planning through a discussion of Japan's proposal to create guidelines for AI Research and Development (R&D).[905] Accordingly, G7 leaders worked to draw the cooperation of international organizations such as the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) to release "AI R&D Guidelines for International Discussions" to serve as the basis for AI-related commitments.

At the 2017 Taormina Summit, G7 leaders emphasized the opportunities of the Next Production Revolution to strengthen competitiveness and innovation-driven growth.[906] They recognized that reshaping production systems could directly benefit micro, small, and medium-sized enterprises (MSMEs) by enabling them to harness digitalization and innovation, while also broadening participation across sectors and regions.

At the 2018 Charlevoix Summit, G7 leaders recognized the importance of promoting the commercial adoption of AI through the Charlevoix Common Vision for the Future of Artificial Intelligence, which acknowledged that realizing the broad potential of AI in entrepreneurship and businesses would require investment and adaptation.[907] Through this commitment, leaders aimed to promote human-centric AI and its commercial adoption, while still safeguarding privacy and personal data.

At the 2023 Hiroshima Summit, the G7 leaders directed the launch of the Hiroshima AI Process after recognizing the need of promoting inclusive AI global governance to effectively take advantage of its innovative opportunities for businesses and AI developers alike.[908] As a result, the Hiroshima AI Process Comprehensive Policy Framework became the first international agreement to set guiding principles to help protect intellectual property; tackle misinformation; and provide a strict code of conduct for the safe and trustworthy development of AI.

At the 2024 Apulia Summit, G7 leaders reiterated their commitment to promoting a safe, secure, and reliable AI by launching the G7 Toolkit for Artificial Intelligence in the Public Sector.[909] Leaders reaffirmed their commitment to develop a reporting initiative with the aim of monitoring organizations that voluntarily implement the Hiroshima AI Process framework. Lastly, leaders committed to collaborate with the Labour Ministers to develop measures that ensure access to digital skill-enhancing tools, taking advantage of the opportunities of the use of AI in the workforce.

At the 2025 Kananaskis Summit, G7 leaders introduced the AI Adoption Roadmap as a practical framework to help SMEs integrate AI into their operations.[910] They committed to sustaining investments in AI adoption programs for SMEs, ensuring that businesses have access to the computing infrastructure, digital resources, and technical expertise needed to scale.

Commitment Features

The primary component of this commitment is that G7 members must "sustain investments in AI adoption programs for SMEs." This component emphasizes the continuity and durability of support,

[905] AI Utilization Guidelines: Practical Reference for AI Utilization, Government of Japan (Tokyo) 9 August 2019. Access Date: 20 September 2025. https://www.soumu.go.jp/main_content/000658284.pdf

[906] G7 Taormina Leaders' Communiqué, G7 Information Centre (Toronto) 27 May 2017. Access Date: 18 November 2025 https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/summit/2017taormina/communique.html

[907] Charlevoix Common Vision for the Future of Artificial Intelligence, G7 Information Centre (Toronto) 9 June 2018. Access Date: 20 September 2025. http://www.g7.utoronto.ca/summit/2018charlevoix/ai-commitment.html

[908] The Hiroshima AI Process: Leading the Global Challenge to Shape Inclusive Governance for Generative AI, Government of Japan (Tokyo) 9 February 2024. Access Date: 20 September 2025. https://www.japan.go.jp/kizuna/2024/02/hiroshima_ai_process.html

[909] Apulia G7 Leaders' Communiqué, G7 Information Centre (Toronto) 14 June 2024. Access Date: 20 September 2025. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/summit/2024apulia/240614-apulia-communique.html

[910] G7 Leaders' Statement on AI for Prosperity (Kananaskis), G7 Information Centre (Toronto) 17 June 2025. Access Date: 18 November 2025. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/summit/2025kananaskis/250617-ai.html

ensuring that SMEs have the resources needed to integrate AI into their operations. The secondary component of the commitment, "including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure" provides one pathway of how such investments may be realized.

Definitions and Concepts

"Sustain" is understood to mean keeping up, prolonging, or supporting something with the intent of continuing to supply it with sustenance.[911] In the context of this commitment, it refers to the continuation of support given for investments in AI adoption programs for SMEs.

"Adoption" is understood to mean the act of beginning to practice or use something.[912] In the context of this commitment, it refers to the practice of SMEs beginning to use AI technology in their systems.

"Access" is understood to mean availability, which can be defined in terms of the "reachability (physical access), affordability (economic access) and acceptability (socio-cultural access) of services that meet a minimum standard of quality. Making services available, affordable and acceptable is an essential precondition for universal access."[913] In the context of this commitment, it refers the availability and access of compute and digital infrastructure.

"Compute and digital infrastructure" is understood to mean the foundational set of technologies, including compute, storage and networks, that support digital services, platforms, and applications.[914]

General Interpretive Guidelines

Full compliance, or a score of +1, will be awarded to G7 members that take at least five strong actions to promote AI adoption in SMEs by sustaining investments in SME-targeted adoption programs. Strong domestic actions include allocating funding for SME AI adoption, enacting legislation that facilitates integration, establishing privacy or consumer protection frameworks, subsidizing access to compute and digital infrastructure, creating SME-specific training centers, publishing toolkits or case studies, and supporting talent exchanges. Strong international actions include financing initiatives that expand SME access to AI, rewarding organizations aligned with Hiroshima AI Process standards, supporting global infrastructure or compute programs, contributing to cross-border partnerships, funding literacy campaigns, and ensuring SMEs in developing economies benefit from shared resources.

Partial compliance, or a score of 0, will be assigned to members that have taken three or four weak actions or up to four strong actions to sustain investments in AI adoption programs for SMEs. Weaker actions include attending conferences, issuing verbal statements of support, endorsing other countries' SME AI policies, launching short-term pilots or one-off grants, creating general AI programs not tailored to SMEs, hosting awareness events without resources, or providing outdated or impractical tools.

Non-compliance, or a score of −1, will be assigned if a member takes two or fewer weak action to support SME AI adoption, or acts in ways that counter investments in AI adoption programs.

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[911] Sustain, Merriam-Webster (Springfield) n.d. Access Date: 20 September 2025. https://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/sustain

[912] Adoption, Merriam-Webster (Springfield) n.d. Access Date: 20 September 2025. https://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/adoption

[913] Compliance Coding Manual for International Institutional Commitments, G7 Information Centre (Toronto) 12 November 2020. Access Date: 20 September 2025. http://www.g7.utoronto.ca/compliance/Compliance_Coding_Manual_2020.pdf

[914] Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI), United Nations Development Programme (New York) n.d. Access Date: 5 October 2025. https://www.undp.org/digital/digital-public-infrastructure

Scoring Guidelines

−1	The G7 member has taken two or fewer weak actions to sustain investments in artificial intelligence (AI) adoption programs for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) or acts in ways that counter investments in AI adoption programs.
0	The G7 member has taken three or four weak actions or up to four strong actions to sustain investments in AI adoption programs for SMEs.
+1	The G7 member has taken five or more strong actions to sustain investments in AI adoption programs for SMEs.

Compliance Director: Mehek Berry
Lead Analyst: Isabella Chan-Combrink

Canada: +1

Canada has fully complied with its commitment to sustain investments in artificial intelligence (AI) adoption programs for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure.

On 25 June 2025, the Government of Canada opened applications for the AI Compute Access Fund, which will provide up to CAD300 million to selected SMEs submit project proposals based on developing Canadian-based AI products and solutions.[915] This will allow Canadian enterprises to compete in the AI sector on a global scale and drive.

On 19 August 2025, the Japan Canadian Technology Accelerator and the National Research Council of Canada Industrial Research Assistance Program announced the upcoming "AI Solutions for Manufacturing and Clean Technologies" in December.[916] This collaboration aims to introduce Canadian SMEs to Japanese firms that seek to incorporate AI tools into their operations so that Canadian SMEs can develop their innovation capabilities, effectively commercialize their digital systems, and increase their competitiveness abroad.

On 22 October 2025, the Minister of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Innovation and Minister responsible for the Federal Economic Development Agency for Southern Ontario, Evan Solomon, announced a financial investment of CAD2.4 million for the Toronto Region Board of Trade for its AI Business Catalyst program.[917] This program will give businesses across different industries in Toronto access to the tools they need to adopt AI solutions, aimed to grow businesses' productivity using AI tools and support the further integration of AI.

On 13 November 2025, the Financial Consumer Agency of Canada and the Global Risk Institute to organize a workshop examining how emerging AI technologies affect financial well-being and

[915] Government of Canada opens applications for the AI Compute Access Fund, Innovation, Science and Economic Development Canada (Ottawa) 25 June 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.canada.ca/en/innovation-science-economic-development/news/2025/06/government-of-canada-opens-applications-for-the-ai-compute-access-fund.html

[916] AI solutions for manufacturing and cleantech Japan - Canadian Technology Accelerator, Government of Canada (Ottawa) 19 August 2025. Access Date: 23 November 2025. https://www.tradecommissioner.gc.ca/en/our-solutions/support-programs/canadian-technology-accelerators/ai-manufacturing-cleantech-japan.html

[917] Government of Canada supports new AI Business Catalyst program, Federal Economic Development Agency for Southern Ontario (Toronto) 26 June 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.canada.ca/en/economic-development-southern-ontario/news/2025/06/government-of-canada-supports-new-ai-business-catalyst-program.html

consumer protection.[918] This aims to build the broader policy and regulatory understanding needed for SMEs to adopt AI safely.

On 8 December 2025, Minister Solomon and Karsten Wildberger, Germany's Minister for Digital Transformation and Government Modernization, released a joint statement at the G7 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministers' Meeting in Montreal.[919] The joint statement advanced a new Canada–Germany Digital Alliance, which works towards cooperation on AI, compute infrastructure, digital innovation and support for business engagement. As part of this initiative, both governments committed to developing a Joint Declaration of Intent on AI that includes areas such as compute infrastructure, AI adoption, talent mobility and opportunities for firms, including SMEs.

On 8 December 2025, at the G7 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministerial Meeting, Canada highlighted a CAD925.6 million commitment to expand national AI compute capacity, establish sovereign public supercomputing infrastructure and accelerate AI deployment across federal institutions, with CAD800 million drawn from previously allocated fiscal resources. Budget 2025 also outlined plans to advance a Sovereign Canadian Cloud, enable the Canada Infrastructure Bank to participate in AI infrastructure financing and launch industry engagement to identify additional large-scale compute projects. By strengthening the country's AI infrastructure base, these measures broaden the resources available to Canadian SMEs, improving their ability to access the compute capacity required to integrate AI tools and applications into their operations.

On 9 December 2025, the G7 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministers issued a declaration aimed towards delivering various aspects of the G7 AI Adoption Roadmap.[920] The declaration commits members to expanding training and informational resources to help SMEs develop the skills needed to use AI, advancing international talent-exchange initiatives that link AI-skilled students and workers with businesses, and encouraging the use of open-source AI tools to broaden access to technical capabilities.

On 9 December 2025, the G7 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministers issued the SME AI Adoption Blueprint outlining coordinated measures to accelerate responsible AI uptake among small and medium-sized enterprises.[921] The statement set out detailed policy recommendations on infrastructure, datasets, open-source tools, AI literacy, workforce development and financial supports, and emphasized the creation of resilient SME-focused AI adoption ecosystems.

On 9 December 2025, the G7 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministers published the "Toolkit for Small and Medium-Sized Enterprises (SMEs) Deploying Artificial Intelligence (AI)."[922] The toolkit aims to provide practical guidance for SME AI deployers, drawing on contributions from G7 members, International Center of Expertise in Montreal on Artificial Intelligence and the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development. By offering tailored, implementation-focused resources

[918] Financial Industry Forum on Artificial Intelligence workshop: interim report, Government of Canada (Ottawa) 22 December 2025. Access Date: 26 December 2025. https://www.canada.ca/en/financial-consumer-agency/news/2025/12/financial-industry-forum-on-artificial-intelligence-workshop-interim-report.html
[919] Joint statement by Canada's Minister Solomon and Germany's Minister Wildberger announcing the Canada-Germany Digital Alliance, Government of Canada (Ottawa) 8 December 2025. Access Date: 27 December 2025. http://canada.ca/en/innovation-science-economic-development/news/2025/12/joint-statement-by-canadas-minister-solomon-and-germanys-minister-wildberger-announcing-the-canada-germany-digital-alliance.html
[920] G7 2025 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministerial Declaration, G7 Information Centre (Toronto) 9 December 2025. Access Date: 28 December 2025. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/ict/2025-declaration.html
[921] G7 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministerial Statement on the SME AI Adoption Blueprint, G7 Information Centre (Ottawa) 9 December 2025. Access Date: 27 December 2025. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/ict/2025-sme-ai-adoption.html
[922] Toolkit for Small- and Medium-Sized Enterprises Deploying Artificial Intelligence, G7 Information Centre(Ottawa) 9 December 2025. Access Date: 28 December 2025. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/ict/g7-mtl-toolkit-en.pdf.

that address the specific challenges SMEs face when adopting trustworthy AI, this initiative strengthens the capacity of smaller firms to integrate AI safely and effectively into their operations.

On 9 December 2025, Canada released a comparative report developed by the Quebec AI Institute, the Vector Institute, and the Alberta Machine Intelligence Institute.[923] The publication synthesizes case studies from all G7 members, incorporates program data and analysis from the three Canadian institutes and includes insights from subject-matter experts to identify factors shaping SME adoption of AI technologies. The report provides an evidence base intended to inform future policy development aimed at supporting SMEs in integrating AI into their operations.

On 10 December 2025, the Italian Embassy in Ottawa announced a declaration of cooperation between Italy and Canada to reaffirm their commitment to their Joint Advisory Group (JAG) on Artificial Intelligence.[924] The JAG is developing a new collaborative project that focuses on fostering the development and adoption of AI solutions in SMEs by enhancing collaboration between the two nations and advancing their mutual priorities.

On 15 December 2025, Minister Solomon announced a CAD6.7 million federal investment through the Federal Economic Development Agency for Southern Ontario (FedDev Ontario) to support the City of Toronto and Coralus in strengthening small businesses. This includes CAD4 million for the City of Toronto to run the Toronto Economic Resiliency Initiative, which offers targeted supports to help local small businesses adapt, upgrade and remain competitive. They also provided an additional to Coralus to expand its programming for women and non-binary entrepreneurs, strengthening their ability to build sustainable and resilient enterprises across the region.

On 17 December 2025, the Canadian Government announced a funding package of over CAD19 million through FedDev Ontario aimed to help 20 AI-focused businesses and organizations in southern Ontario develop new AI technologies and accelerate adoption across sectors.[925]

On 6 February 2026, the Minister of Northern and Arctic Affairs and Minister responsible for the Canadian Northern Economic Development Agency (CanNor), Rebecca Chartrand, announced an investment of over CAD2.8 million to support the creation of an "AI-Driven Entrepreneurship and Business Support Centre."[926] This funding will be delivered through CanNor, and will provide Nunavut, the Northwest Territories and the Yukon with support to develop and integrate AI tools in northern SMEs and communities. This aims to increase greater accessibility and affordability to integrate AI as an active part of operations in SMEs.

On 14 February 2026, Canada and Germany signed a Joint Declaration of Intent on Artificial Intelligence at the Munich Security Conference, led by Evan Solomon and Karsten Wildberger.[927] The

[923] Artificial Intelligence Adoption by Small- and Medium-Sized Enterprises: Insights from G7 Case Studies and Canada's Experience, Government of Canada (Ottawa) 9 December 2025. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/ict/2025g7aiadoptionfinaleng-1.pdf Access Date: 27 December 2025.

[924] Statement on Canada-Italy Cooperation in Artificial Intelligence, Ambasciata d'Italia Ottawa (Ottawa) 10 December 2025. Access Date: 20 February 2025. https://ambottawa.esteri.it/en/news/dall_ambasciata/2025/12/statement-on-canada-italy-cooperation-in-artificial-intelligence/

[925] Government of Canada fuels AI growth for businesses in southern Ontario, Government of Canada (Ottawa) 17 December 2025. Access Date: 27 December 2025. https://www.canada.ca/en/economic-development-southern-ontario/news/2025/12/government-of-canada-fuels-ai-growth-for-businesses-in-southern-ontario.html

[926] Minister Chartrand announces over $2.8M in AI to advance economic growth and digital literacy, Canadian Northern Economic Development Agency (Yellowknife) 6 February 2026. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.canada.ca/en/northern-economic-development/news/2026/02/minister-chartrand-announces-over-28m-in-ai-to-advance-economic-growth-and-digital-literacy0.html

[927] Canada and Germany sign AI joint declaration and launch Sovereign Technology Alliance, Government of Canada (Munich) 14 February 2026. Access Date: 31 March 2026. https://www.canada.ca/en/innovation-science-economic-development/news/2026/02/canada-and-germany-sign-ai-joint-declaration-and-launch-sovereign-technology-alliance.html

declaration builds on the Canada-Germany Digital Alliance announced on 8 December 2025 and establishes a framework for cooperation in areas such as AI infrastructure, research, commercialization and talent development. Alongside this, both governments launched the Sovereign Technology Alliance to strengthen collaboration on advanced technologies and reduce technological dependencies.

On 18 March 2026, the Atlantic Canada Opportunities Agency (ACOA) published their 2026-2027 departmental plan, which announced that increasing AI adoption in SMEs was one of three key priorities.[928] The plan pledged to provide tailored and client-centric assistance to SMEs, including by expanding the Regional Artificial Intelligence Initiative, launched in 2024 with a budget of CAD200 million to grant to chosen SMEs for the purpose of AI adoption.[929] This aims to help Atlantic Canadian SMEs mitigate economic and budget insecurity, increase regional competitiveness and improve accessibility to AI integration.

On 19 March 2026, Minister of National Defense David J. McGuinty announced that the National Research Council of Canada would be investing over CAD900 million in emerging technologies, including quantum computing, sensing and communications.[930]

On 14 April 2026, Minister Solomon and Finnish Minister of Economic Affairs, Sakari Puisto, reaffirmed Canada's and Finland's commitment to enhance bilateral cooperation in areas including promoting the integration of AI into SMEs to increase investment and business prospects.[931]

On 15 April 2026, the Government of Canada launched the AI Sovereign Compute Infrastructure Program, opening applications to develop large-scale, Canadian-based supercomputing systems.[932] This initiative supports significant investment in national digital infrastructure by enabling the design and operation of high-performance computing systems to advance artificial intelligence research and innovation.

On 21 April 2026, Minister of Industry Mélanie Joly announced a CAD23 million investment to Siemens Canada to support the expansion of a Global AI Manufacturing Technologies Research and Development Centre for battery production.[933] This initiative aims to strengthen the adoption of artificial intelligence in manufacturing by supporting research, development and commercialization of AI-driven technologies.

[928] Atlantic Canada Opportunities Agency 2026-27 Departmental Plan, Atlantic Canada Opportunities Agency (Moncton) 18 March 2026. Access Date: 12 April 2026. https://www.canada.ca/en/atlantic-canada-opportunities/corporate/transparency/2026-27-departmental-plan.html

[929] Regional Artificial Intelligence Initiative, Atlantic Canada Opportunities Agency (Moncton) 11 March 2025. Access Date: 12 April 2026. https://www.canada.ca/en/atlantic-canada-opportunities/services/regional-artificial-intelligence-initiative.html

[930] Canada advances Defence Industrial Strategy to strengthen security, sovereignty and prosperity, Innovation, Science and Economic Development Canada (Ottawa) 19 March 2026. Access Date: 2 April 2026. https://www.canada.ca/en/innovation-science-economic-development/news/2026/03/canada-advances-defence-industrial-strategy-to-strengthen-security-sovereignty-and-prosperity

[931] Canada-Finland Joint Statement on Sovereign Technology and AI Cooperation, Innovation, Science and Economic Development Canada (Ottawa) 14 April 2026. Access Date: 19 April 2026. https://www.canada.ca/en/innovation-science-economic-development/news/2026/04/canada-finland-joint-statement-on-sovereign-technology-and-ai-cooperation.html

[932] Canada launches national initiative to build large-scale AI supercomputing capacity, Innovation, Science and Economic Development Canada (Ottawa) 15 April 2026. Access Date: 26 April 2026. https://www.canada.ca/en/innovation-science-economic-development/news/2026/04/canada-launches-national-initiative-to-build-large-scale-ai-supercomputing-capacity.html

[933] Minister Joly announces $23 million investment in major Siemens' $70 million project for a Canadian R&D centre while at HANNOVER MESSE in Germany, Innovation, Science and Economic Development Canada (Ottawa) 21 April 2026. Access Date: 26 April 2026. https://www.canada.ca/en/innovation-science-economic-development/news/2026/04/minister-joly-announces-23-million-investment-in-major-siemens-70-million-project-for-a-canadian-rd-centre-while-at-hannover-messe-in-germany.html

Canada has fully complied with its commitment to sustain investments in AI adoption programs for SMEs, including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure. Canada has demonstrated at least five strong actions that support this commitment, including through financial investment programs that promote the research and development of domestic AI programs across the country for SMEs. Therefore, Canada continues to sustain investments and support access to compute and digital infrastructure for SMEs.

Thus, Canada receives a score of +1.

Analyst: Mai Linh Pham Dac

France: +1

France has fully complied with its commitment to sustain investments in artificial intelligence (AI) adoption programs for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure.

On 18 September 2025, the French government launched the "AI Pioneers" program, which aims to finance domestic project proposals that support the research and development of AI innovation.[934] This initiative will make the development of AI more affordable and accessible to businesses, with a focus on those who work in the industrial sector. The program will also finance between EUR3 million and EUR8 million for selected enterprises over the course of three years.

On 18 September 2025, the French government launched the "Osez l'IA" plan, which aims to accelerate the adoption of AI tools in SMEs through a three-step plan involving the hosting of networking events centred around AI, training professionals through an AI academy, and assisting SMEs in identifying relevant AI solutions.[935] This will assist in promoting the various usages of AI, as well as ensuring that businesses have the financial funds and strategic knowledge to successfully integrate AI into their activities.

On 7 November 2025, the French government announced an action plan to revitalize small businesses, which included measures to help SMEs integrate AI with tools and adaptable programs via an "AI Academy."[936] This new action is part of the larger AI integration program previously announced as "Dare to Embrace AI." The "AI Academy" will allow SMEs to access user-friendly AI tools, tailor them to their specific needs, and introduce a network of ambassadors to promote AI and aid businesses in its integration tools on the ground. This aims to strengthen SME productivity and competitiveness in local and national markets.

On 26 November 2025, the French government launched the program "Important Projects of Common European Interests" (PIIEC), which allows EU member states to access a common framework that allows them to finance private individual projects that stimulate AI innovation in

[934] France 2030: Lancement de l'appel à projet « Pionniers de l'intelligence artificielle », Secrétariat général pour l'investissement (SGPI) (Paris) 18 September 2025. Translation provided by Analyst. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.info.gouv.fr/actualite/france-2030-lancement-de-l-appel-a-projet-pionniers-de-l-intelligence-artificielle
[935] Osez l'IA : un plan pour diffuser l'IA dans toutes les entreprises, Ministère de l'Économie, des Finances et de la Souveraineté industrielle et numérique (Paris) 18 September 2025. Translation provided by Analyst. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.economie.gouv.fr/actualites/osez-lia-un-plan-pour-diffuser-lia-dans-toutes-leais-entreprises
[936] 9 mesures pour redynamiser le commerce de proximité, Ministère de l'Économie, des Finances et de la Souveraineté industrielle et numérique (Paris) 7 November 2025. Translation provided by analyst. Access Date: 02 December 2025. https://www.economie.gouv.fr/actualites/9-mesures-pour-redynamiser-le-commerce-de-proximite

industries.[937] This program will focus specifically on the dissemination of AI technology in the industrial sector across Europe, creating strong partnerships between different industries across borders. This will help local French SMEs access funding to obtain advanced AI technology, build new international industrial partnerships, and integrate AI solutions into their production processes.

On 30 January 2026, the Minister Delegate of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Affairs, Anne Le Hénanff, reconvened with stakeholders responsible for increasing AI adoption in SMEs through the implementation of data center sites, with the objective of developing further strategies to accelerate AI deployment.[938] As an extension of the February 2025 AI Action Summit, the government has provided support to 52 companies who are implementing AI into their operations. This initiative aims to provide infrastructure for SMEs to deploy AI on a large scale, while keeping their data within the country, creating a coordinated ecosystem.

On 31 March 2026, the Minister of Economy, Finance and Industrial Energy and Digital Sovereignty, Roland Lescure, announced the state of France's EUR404 million acquisition of advanced AI computing brand Bull from technology company Atos Group.[939] The acquisition intended to increase France's sovereignty over its domestic AI operations and prevent Bull from being acquired by foreign stakeholders. As Bull has the only supercomputer factory in Europe, which is recognized for its ability to train large AI models, this effort aims to reinvigorate the French AI industry, facilitate AI integration into SMEs and overcome challenges that French SMEs may face with the rapid evolution of AI in the international market.

On 16 April 2026, the French government and Advanced Micro Devices, Inc. signed a letter of intent to expand access to advanced artificial intelligence compute resources as part of France's national AI strategy.[940] This multi-year collaboration supports the development of AI infrastructure, including the planned Alice Recoque exascale supercomputer, and provides hardware, software and training to researchers, developers and startups through dedicated programs.

France has fully complied with its commitment to sustain investments in AI adoption programs for small and SMEs, including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure. France has demonstrated five strong actions since the Kananaskis Summit. France has provided financial support to SMEs to develop AI through projects centered on research and development, which include developing frameworks for SMEs to receive the funding they need to integrate AI into their existing infrastructure, providing training and promotion of AI tools to SME leaders to educate them on AI solutions and implementing data centers while supporting SMEs in the process, which ensure the long-term sustainability of AI development.

[937] Intelligence artificielle : le Gouvernement lance un appel à manifestation d'intérêt pour sélectionner des projets nationaux, Ministère de l'Économie, des Finances et de la Souveraineté industrielle et numérique (Paris) 26 November 2025. Translation provided by analyst. Access Date: 2 December 2025. https://www.economie.gouv.fr/actualites/intelligence-artificielle-le-gouvernement-lance-un-appel-manifestation-dinteret-pour-selectionner-des-projets-nationaux

[938] Rencontres des centres de données : la dynamique des projets d'infrastructures numériques se confirme, Ministère de l'Économie, des Finances et de la Souveraineté industrielle, énergétique et numérique (Paris) 30 January 2026. Translation provided by analyst. Access Date: 17 February 2026 https://www.economie.gouv.fr/actualites/rencontres-des-centres-de-donnees-la-dynamique-des-projets-dinfrastructures-numeriques-se-confirme

[939] L'État finalise l'acquisition de Bull et positionne la France à la pointe du calcul haute performance et de l'IA, Ministère de l'Économie, des Finances et de la Souveraineté industrielle, énergétique et numérique (Paris) 31 Mars 2026. Translation provided by Google Translate. Access Date: 18 March 2026. https://presse.economie.gouv.fr/letat-finalise-lacquisition-de-bull-et-positionne-la-france-a-la-pointe-du-calcul-haute-performance-et-de-lia/

[940] AMD and the French Government Announce Plans to Advance AI Innovation, Research and Open Ecosystem Development in France, AMD (Paris). April 16 2026. Access Date: 26 April 2026. https://www.amd.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2026-4-16-amd-and-the-french-government-announce-plans-to-advance.html

Thus, France receives a score of +1.

Analyst: Mai Linh Pham Dac

Germany: +1

Germany has fully complied with its commitment to sustain investments in artificial intelligence (AI) adoption programs for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure.

On 30 September 2025, the Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development published the BMZ Data Strategy, in which it announced its intentions to draw up a ministry-wide strategy to introduce AI responsibly in administration and data analysis.[941] However, this report was based on data collected in September 2024, which indicates limited recent progress.

On 13 November 2025, the Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs and Energy hosted the Mittelstand Digital Congress, in which AI experts participated in various panels educating SMEs on how to successfully integrate AI technology into their businesses.[942] The aim of the Congress was to impart practical knowledge to SME leaders on how to safely integrate AI to protect their businesses from digital threats, legal challenges, and regulatory constraints. This will give SMEs the information they need to maximize AI potential and create reliable AI tools to use in business activities.

On 18 November 2025, Germany and France co-hosted the European Summit on Digital Sovereignty in Berlin, bringing together over 1,000 participants including digital ministers from 23 EU member states.[943] The summit aimed to reduce Europe's technological dependencies by promoting European-developed AI, cloud infrastructure and open-source solutions. Through keynote speeches, panel discussions and exhibitions showcasing innovations in quantum computing, sovereign AI and green data centers, the summit provided European business leaders and SMEs with strategic frameworks to adopt homegrown technologies and build competitive advantages while maintaining digital security.

On 8 December 2025, Karsten Wildberger, Minister for Digital Transformation and Government Modernization, and Evan Solomon, Canada's Minister of Artificial Intelligence and Digital Innovation, released a joint statement at the G7 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministers' Meeting in Montreal.[944] The joint statement advanced a new Canada–Germany Digital Alliance, which works towards cooperation on AI, compute infrastructure, digital innovation and support for business engagement. As part of this initiative, both governments committed to developing a Joint Declaration of Intent on AI that includes areas such as compute infrastructure, AI adoption, talent mobility and opportunities for firms, including SMEs.

On 9 December 2025, the G7 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministers issued a joint statement on the SME AI Adoption Blueprint outlining coordinated measures to accelerate responsible AI uptake

[941] BMZ Data Strategy, Federal Ministry for Economic Cooperation and Development (Berlin) 2 October 2025. Access Date: 30 October 2025. https://www.bmz.de/resource/blob/250012/bmz-datenstrategie-en.pdf

[942] Mittelstand-Digital Kongress 2025: Impulse für KI-Einsatz und Cybersicherheit im Mittelstand, Bundesministerium für Wirtschaft und Energie (Berlin) 13 November 2025. Translated by Analyst. Access Date: 11 December 2025. https://www.bundeswirtschaftsministerium.de/Redaktion/DE/Pressemitteilungen/2025/11/20251113-mittelstand-digital-kongress-2025.html

[943] Summit for More Digital Sovereignty Starts in Berlin, Federal Ministry for Digital Transformation and Government Modernisation (Berlin) 17 November 2025. Access Date: 15 February 2026. https://bmds.bund.de/aktuelles/pressemitteilungen/detail/summit-for-more-digital-sovereignty-starts-in-berlin

[944] Joint statement by Canada's Minister Solomon and Germany's Minister Wildberger announcing the Canada-Germany Digital Alliance, Government of Canada (Ottawa) 8 December 2025. Access Date: 27 December 2025. http://canada.ca/en/innovation-science-economic-development/news/2025/12/joint-statement-by-canadas-minister-solomon-and-germanys-minister-wildberger-announcing-the-canada-germany-digital-alliance.html

among small and medium-sized enterprises.[945] The statement set out detailed policy recommendations on infrastructure, datasets, open-source tools, AI literacy, workforce development and financial supports, and emphasized the creation of resilient SME-focused AI adoption ecosystems.

On 9 December 2025, the G7 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministers published the "Toolkit for Small and Medium-Sized Enterprises Deploying Artificial Intelligence."[946] The toolkit aims to provide practical guidance for SME AI deployers, drawing on contributions from G7 members, International Center of Expertise in Montreal on Artificial Intelligence and the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development. By offering tailored, implementation-focused resources that address the specific challenges SMEs face when adopting trustworthy AI, this initiative strengthens the capacity of smaller firms to integrate AI safely and effectively into their operations.

On 13 January 2026, the Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs and Energy (BMWE) and the European Investment Fund (EIF) announced the expansion of their partnership through the new EIF German Equity program, providing EUR1.6 billion in additional financing for technology-based startups and SMEs.[947] The program aims to strengthen the equity base of young technology companies across sectors including AI, digitalization, FinTech, energy and life sciences by improving access to venture capital and growth funds. Through this "fund-of-funds" approach that mobilizes private capital at approximately five times the public investment, the initiative provides startups and SMEs with reliable financing pathways, innovations into competitive business models and pathways into international technology leaders while remaining in Europe.

On 14 February 2026, Canada and Germany signed a Joint Declaration of Intent on Artificial Intelligence at the Munich Security Conference, led by Evan Solomon and Karsten Wildberger.[948] The declaration builds on the Canada-Germany Digital Alliance announced on 8 December 2025 and establishes a framework for cooperation in areas such as AI infrastructure, research, commercialization and talent development. Alongside this, both governments launched the Sovereign Technology Alliance to strengthen collaboration on advanced technologies and reduce technological dependencies. These initiatives support firms, including SMEs, by improving access to infrastructure and innovation ecosystems, although they do not provide direct, targeted support for SME AI adoption.

On 18 February 2026, German Federal Minister for Digital Transformation and Government Modernisation, Karsten Wildberger, and Indian Minister of Electronics and Information Technology, Ashwini Vaishnaw, agreed to jointly establish the India-Germany AI Pact to increase cooperation between both countries across key areas related to artificial intelligence.[949] Among other things, the India-Germany AI Pact aims to increase the rapid adoption of AI for start-ups, tech firms and SMEs.

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[945] G7 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministerial Statement on the SME AI Adoption Blueprint, G7 Information Centre (Ottawa) 9 December 2025. Access Date: 27 December 2025. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/ict/2025-sme-ai-adoption.html

[946] Toolkit for Small- and Medium-Sized Enterprises Deploying Artificial Intelligence, Government of Canada (Ottawa) 9 December 2025. Access Date: 28 December 2025. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/ict/g7-mtl-toolkit-en.pdf.

[947] €1.6 Billion for Innovation: Economic Affairs Ministry and EIF Expand Finance for Startups in EIF German Equity, Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs and Energy (Berlin) 13 January 2026. Access Date: 15 February 2026. https://www.bundeswirtschaftsministerium.de/Redaktion/EN/Pressemitteilungen/2026/01/20260113-economic-affairs-ministry-and-eif-expand-finance-for-startups-in-eif-german-equity.html

[948] Canada and Germany sign AI joint declaration and launch Sovereign Technology Alliance, Government of Canada (Munich) 14 February 2026. Access Date: 31 March 2026. https://www.canada.ca/en/innovation-science-economic-development/news/2026/02/canada-and-germany-sign-ai-joint-declaration-and-launch-sovereign-technology-alliance.html

[949] Joint Press Release on Germany–India AI Pact, Bundesministerium für Digitales und Staatsmodernisierung (Berlin) 18 February 2026. Translation provided by Google Translate. Access Date: 11 March 2026. https://bmds.bund.de/aktuelles/pressemitteilungen/detail/deutschland-und-indien-schliessen-pakt-fuer-ki

On 2 March 2026, the Federal Ministry for Digital Affairs and Public Sector initiated a public consultation for SMEs, research centers and public institutions to create a funding guideline to promote the use of AI for commercial applications.[950]

On 15 April 2026, the German Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs and Climate Action organized the Zukunftstag Mittelstand 2026, a major national event for Germany's SME sector that brought together policymakers, technology experts, and business leaders to advance the adoption of AI data, cloud computing, and digital infrastructure.[951] The event showcased practical AI and data solutions, secure cloud and connectivity services, and digital transformation tools tailored to SMEs, with a focus on improving efficiency, compliance, and innovation, as well as strengthening the competitiveness and digital sovereignty of the Mittelstand.

Germany has fully complied with its commitment to sustain investments in AI adoption programs for SMEs, including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure. Germany has taken concrete actions such as hosting a conference to educate SME leaders on how to navigate legal and technical regulations when integrating AI, joining Canada in announcing the Canada–Germany Digital Alliance. Germany has also demonstrated multiple strong actions since the Kananaskis Summit, including expanding financing for technology-based SMEs through the EIF German Equity program, advancing international cooperation through the Canada–Germany Digital Alliance and the India–Germany AI Pact, and supporting SME-focused knowledge and adoption through initiatives such as the Mittelstand Digital Congress

Thus, Germany receives a score of +1.

Analyst: Ece Onal

Italy: +1

Italy has fully complied with its commitment to sustain investments in artificial intelligence (AI) adoption programs for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure.

On 19 June 2025, Minister of Enterprise and Made in Italy Adolfo Urso signed a Memorandum of Understanding with the Republic of Congo to support local startups in healthcare, agriculture, education and logistics through the usage of technology incorporating AI.[952] This action will help accelerate SMEs in adopting AI by reducing barriers to and improving access to AI technology.

On 20 June 2025, the Ministry of Enterprise and Made in Italy and the United Nations Development Programme officially opened the AI Hub for Sustainable Development platform of public-private partnerships as part of the Mattei Plan to accelerate growth in Africa through utilizing AI.[953] This action

[950] Funding guidelines for breakthrough innovations in AI and key digital technologies are currently being developed, Federal Ministry for Digital Affairs and Public Sector (Berlin) 2 March 2026. Translation provided by Google Translate. Access Date: 20 April 2026. https://bmds.bund.de/aktuelles/aktuelle-meldungen/detail/foerderrichtlinie-fuer-durchbruchsinnovationen-in-ki-und-digitalen-schluesseltechnologien-in-arbeit

[951] Zukunftstag 2026: AI & Data for the Mittelstand, Deutsche Telekom AG (Berlin) 10 April 2026. Access Date: 26 April 2026. https://dih.telekom.com/en/events/zukunftstag-2026

[952] AI Hub: Urso firma 4 accordi al Mimit e incontra i ministri di Congo ed Egitto, Ministero delle Imprese e del Made in Italy (Rome) 19 June 2025. Translation provided by Google Translate. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.mimit.gov.it/it/notizie-stampa/ai-hub-urso-firma-4-accordi-al-mimit-e-incontra-i-ministri-di-congo-ed-egitto

[953] Inaugurato a Roma l'AI Hub per lo Sviluppo Sostenibile, Ministero delle Imprese e del Made in Italy (Rome) 20 June 2025. Translation provided by Google Translate. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.mimit.gov.it/it/notizie-stampa/inaugurato-a-roma-lai-hub-per-lo-sviluppo-sostenibile

aims to strengthen sustainable and energy-efficient AI infrastructure so that African SMEs may use it to promote economic growth.

On 17 July 2025, Minister of Enterprise and Made in Italy Adolfo Urso met with Executive Vice-President of the European Commission for Technological Sovereignty, Security and Democracy Henna Virkkunen, in which Minister Urso highlighted the significant role that the AI4Industry foundation based in Turin plays in supporting AI adoption by businesses and SMEs in particular.[954] This meeting reaffirmed Italy's commitment to SME AI adoption.

On 7 November 2025, the Ministry of Enterprise and Made in Italy (MIMIT) announced the recipients of the SMAU 2025 Innovation Award, celebrating Italy's best innovative and digitally transformative projects funded by MIMIT.[955] Alongside the startup Switch, CTE Next, the Turin municipality's emerging technology hub, was a recipient of the award in its work in leveraging AI to optimize vehicle mobility. This award reaffirms Italy's commitment to supporting investment into AI adoption in startups through technology hubs.

On 10 November 2025, the Italian Institute of Artificial Intelligence (AI4I), the Chamber of Commerce of Turin and the Piemonte Innova Foundation launched AI Match, which is a national pilot programme aimed at making AI more accessible to SMEs.[956] AI Match will support SMEs in integrating AI by providing training and orientation on the potential uses of AI, 'smart matching' between companies and solution providers, designing industrial projects and offering voucher-based financial support. This will support the accessibility of compute and digital infrastructure for SMEs and further provide opportunities to integrate AI technology.

On 24 November 2025, the Ministry of Enterprise and Made in Italy announced that Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni discussed building AI infrastructure value chains throughout the Lobito corridor at the African Union-European Union Business Forum.[957] This dialogue is in accordance with the Mattei Plan to accelerate growth in Africa through the utilization of AI.

On 5 September 2025, Minister of University and Research Anna Maria Bernini along with European Commission Vice-President Henna Virkkunen and National Cybersecurity Agency Director General Bruno Frattasi announced the operational opening of the IT4LIA AI Factory, one of Europe's first AI dedicated factories.[958] This jointly funded undertaking will seek to promote the adoption of AI in SMEs and push for greater partnerships between SMEs, research institutions and the information technology industry through better access to compute and digital infrastructure.

[954] UE: Urso incontra la Vicepresidente esecutiva Virkkunen. Ampia intesa sui principali dossier tecnologici, Ministero delle Imprese e del Made in Italy (Rome) 17 July 2025. Translation provided by Google Translate. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.mimit.gov.it/it/notizie-stampa/ue-urso-incontra-la-vicepresidente-esecutiva-virkkunen-ampia-intesa-sui-principali-dossier-tecnologici

[955] Le Case delle Tecnologie Emergenti di Cagliari, Matera, Napoli, Taranto e Torino vincono il Premio Innovazione SMAU 2025, Ministero delle Imprese e del Made in Italy (Rome) 7 November 2025. Translation provided by Google Translate. Access Date: 30 November 2025. https://www.mimit.gov.it/it/notizie-stampa/le-case-delle-tecnologie-emergenti-di-cagliari-matera-napoli-taranto-e-torino-vincono-il-premio-innovazione-smau-2025

[956] AI Match: A National Pilot to Support SMEs in Adopting AI, Starting from Turin, The Italian Institute of Artificial Intelligence for Industry (Turin) 11 November 2025. Access Date: 11 December 2025. https://ai4i.it/2025/11/11/ai-match-a-national-pilot-to-support-smes-in-adopting-ai-starting-from-turin/

[957] Building Africa's AI Ecosystem: Infrastructure for Tomorrow, Resources for Today, Ministry of Enterprise and Made in Italy (Rome) 24 November 2025. Access Date: 30 November 2025. https://www.mimit.gov.it/en/media-tools/news/building-africas-ai-ecosystem

[958] Kick-off for the IT4LIA Project, One of Europe's First AI Factories, National Institute for Nuclear Physics (Rome) 5 September 2025. Access Date: 14 February 2026. https://www.infn.it/en/kick-off-for-the-it4lia-project-one-of-europes-first-ai-factories/

On 10 December 2025, the Ministry of Enterprise and Made in Italy announced a declaration of cooperation between Italy and Canada to reaffirm their commitment to their Joint Advisory Group (JAG) on Artificial Intelligence.[959] The JAG is currently developing a new collaborative project that focuses on fostering the development and adoption of AI solutions in SMEs, with the intention of presenting the products in a 2026 workshop hosted in Italy.

On 10 February 2026, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International cooperation, the Italian embassy in Nairobi, the Ministry of Enterprise and Made in Italy, the Ministry of University and Research, Kenya and the United Nations Development Programme jointly announced four new partnerships under the Mattei Plan to accelerate growth in Africa through utilizing artificial intelligence.[960] The Harmonic Africa Startup Acceleration Program, in collaboration with the AI Hub for Sustainable Development, aims to provide AI startups with financial resources and assistance, including a EUR50 million endowment and creation of an Italian incubator in Africa. The Cybersecurity Readiness Initiative for African AI Startups was another new partnership launched in collaboration with the AI Hub to train and upgrade the cybersecurity of African AI startups. These two partnerships will provide increased funding, security and accessibility to new African SMEs.

On 16 March 2026, the European Union-run interregional cooperation programme, Interreg, hosted a meeting between Italy and Greece in Leece, Italy, to review the progress of the SME-centred project InnoConnect launched in 2025.[961] InnoConnect, which is jointly funded by the Interreg Greece-Italy 2021-2027 programme, aims to promote cross-border innovation and collaboration between SMEs through developing AI tools, open communication and investment partnerships. The meeting reviewed progress on a highly-anticipated AI-based matchmaking platform that aims to pair SMEs with investors and producers, which will facilitate growth and development for both countries and provide SMEs with access to funding and partnerships.

On 24 March 2026, the AI4I announced its strategic partnership with Irish-American consulting firm Accenture to accelerate the adoption of AI across Italian SMEs.[962] The partnership will establish a framework for the development and application of AI across Italian SMEs to offload the work of document management, inventory forecasting and demand prediction, with the objective of raising competitiveness and productivity in the domestic Italian industry. This partnership is estimated to generate up to EU200 billion in additional annual revenues in Europe and aims to provide SMEs with more accessible access to AI adoption across Italy.

Italy has fully complied with its commitment to sustain investments in AI adoption programs for SMEs by demonstrating over five strong actions, including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure. Italy has demonstrated six strong actions since the Kananaskis Summit, five of which have supported access to compute and digital infrastructure. With bilateral agreements including a Memorandum of Understanding with the Republic of Congo, the launch of the AI Hub for Sustainable Development platform as part of the Mattei Plan to accelerate growth in Africa and the launch of the

[959] Dichiarazione sulla cooperazione tra Canada e Italia nel campo dell'intelligenza artificiale, Ministero delle Imprese e del Made in Italy (Rome) 10 December 2025. Translation provided by Google Translate. Access Date: 14 February 2026. https://www.mimit.gov.it/it/comunicati/dichiarazione-sulla-cooperazione-tra-canada-e-italia-nel-campo-dellintelligenza-artificiale
[960] L'AI Hub protagonista del 'Nairobi AI Forum' organizzato da Italia, Kenya e Undp: annunciati 4 protocolli d'intesa, Ministero delle Imprese e del Made in Italy (Rome) 10 February 2026. Translation provided by Google Translate. Access Date: 14 February 2026. https://www.mimit.gov.it/it/notizie-stampa/lai-hub-protagonista-del-nairobi-ai-forum-organizzato-da-italia-kenya-e-undp-annunciati-4-protocolli-dintesa
[961] InnoConnect meeting in Leece to boost SME through AI and digital solutions, Interreg Greece-Italy (Rome) 28 March 2026. Access Date: 12 April 2026. https://www.greece-italy.eu/innoconnect-meeting-in-lecce-to-boost-sme-through-ai-and-digital-solutions/
[962] AI4I and Accenture announce strategic partnership to accelerate AI adoption in Italy's industrial system, Istituto Italiano di Intelligenza Artificale (Rome) 24 March 2026. Access Date: 12 April 2026. https://ai4i.it/2026/03/24/ai4i-and-accenture-announce-strategic-partnership-to-accelerate-ai-adoption-in-italys-industrial-system/

IT4LIA AI Factory to provide greater access to compute and digital infrastructure, Italy has taken key actions to support AI funding, accessibility, partnerships and infrastructure for SMEs domestically and internationally.

Thus, Italy receives a score of +1.

Analyst: Anson Hu

Japan: 0

Japan has partially complied with its commitment to sustain investments in artificial intelligence (AI) adoption programs for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure.

On 1 September 2025, the Japanese government fully enforced the Act on Promotion of Research and Development, and Utilization of AI-related Technology that was introduced on 28 May 2025.[963] This act aims to formulate AI regulations in accordance with international norms and promote the research and development of AI, reflecting the government's intent to expand domestic innovation while reducing reliance on foreign AI services. Furthermore, by coordinating research and setting guidelines to safeguard citizens' rights and data, the measure supports responsible AI integration within SMEs and the wider private sector.

On 11 September 2025, the Japanese government established the AI Strategy Headquarters to promote the secure and trustworthy integration of AI into Japanese businesses, particularly SMEs.[964] Additionally, this strategy aims to help SMEs address problems through AI-assisted mechanisms, such as intelligent automation for labor shortages; predictive analytics to improve the efficiency of supply chains; and enlarge access to markets through data-powered marketing.

On 28 November 2025, the OECD published a report on the role of AI in Japan's labor market, which identified critical barriers to AI adoption among SMEs.[965] The report includes the Japanese government's efforts to implement several measures to support the integration of AI in SMEs, such as the Human Resources Development Subsidies provided by the Ministry of Health, Labor and Welfare for AI-related company training, as well as the Educational Training Benefits program to support worker reskilling and upskilling. However, these actions range from 2015 to 2025, which indicates limited recent progress, and does not fulfill the commitment to support access to compute and digital infrastructure.

On 9 December 2025, the G7 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministers issued a joint statement on the SME AI Adoption Blueprint outlining coordinated measures to accelerate responsible AI uptake among small and medium-sized enterprises.[966] The statement set out detailed policy recommendations on infrastructure, datasets, open-source tools, AI literacy, workforce development and financial supports, and emphasized the creation of resilient SME-focused AI adoption ecosystems.

[963] Japan's Agile AI Governance in Action: Fostering a Global Nexus Through Pluralistic Interoperability, Center for Strategic & International Studies (Washington D.C.) 9 October 2025. Access Date: 12 November 2025. https://www.csis.org/analysis/japans-agile-ai-governance-action-fostering-global-nexus-through-pluralistic

[964] Japan's AI Blueprint: 3 Powerful Ways the National Strategy Will Boost Every Business, I Can Japan AI (Tokyo) 11 September 2025. Access Date: 23 November 2025. https://www.icanjapan.ai/blog/japan-ai-strategy-business-empowerment

[965] Artificial Intelligence and the Labor Market in Japan, Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (Paris) 28 November 2025. Access Date: 15 February 2026. https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/artificial-intelligence-and-the-labour-market-in-japan_b825563e-en.html

[966] G7 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministerial Statement on the SME AI Adoption Blueprint, G7 Information Centre (Ottawa) 9 December 2025. Access Date: 27 December 2025. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/ict/2025-sme-ai-adoption.html

On 9 December 2025, the G7 Industry, Digital and Technology Ministers published the "Toolkit for Small and Medium-Sized Enterprises (SMEs) Deploying Artificial Intelligence (AI)."[967] The toolkit aims to provide practical guidance for SME AI deployers, drawing on contributions from G7 members, International Center of Expertise in Montreal on Artificial Intelligence and the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development. By offering tailored, implementation-focused resources that address the specific challenges SMEs face when adopting trustworthy AI, this initiative strengthens the capacity of smaller firms to integrate AI safely and effectively into their operations.

On 22 December 2025, the Government of Japan approved its first basic plan on AI, establishing a national framework to expand the use of AI across society and strengthen domestic development capabilities.[968] A key element of the plan is the acceleration of AI adoption, including measures intended to support the uptake of AI tools and systems within enterprises as part of a broader effort to modernize production and administrative processes. The plan also sets priorities for enhancing national development capacity, advancing governance and rule-making and updating institutional frameworks. Alongside these measures, the plan includes initiatives to reinforce research institutions and develop AI-related human resources.

On 6 March 2026, the Digital Agency of Japan announced the launch of a large-scale pilot project for its Government AI system "GENNAI," targeting approximately 180,000 employees across all ministries and agencies.[969] The initiative aims to expand the use of generative AI in public administration, improve workforce productivity and strengthen government capacity in AI deployment. The project aligns with Japan's Basic Plan on Artificial Intelligence, emphasizing the government's role in leading AI adoption. By developing shared AI infrastructure, enhancing datasets and promoting practical use among public servants, the initiative is intended to stimulate broader AI adoption and investment in the private sector, including among SMEs, although its impact remains indirect.

Japan has partially complied with its commitment to sustain investments in AI adoption programs for SMEs, including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure. Japan has established the AI Strategy Headquarters to advance SME-focused AI integration, and embedded enterprise-oriented adoption measures in its first national basic AI plan. However, Japan has taken fewer than five strong actions in line with its commitment since the Kananaskis Summit.

Thus, Japan receives a score of 0.

Analyst: Ece Onal

United Kingdom: +1

The United Kingdom has fully complied with its commitment to sustain investments in artificial intelligence (AI) adoption programs for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure.

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[967] Toolkit for Small- and Medium-Sized Enterprises Deploying Artificial Intelligence, Government of Canada (Ottawa) 9 December 2025. Access Date: 28 December 2025. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/ict/g7-mtl-toolkit-en.pdf. https://www.g7.utoronto.ca/ict/g7-mtl-toolkit-en.pdf.

[968] Japanese government approves first basic AI plan, NHK World Japan (Tokyo) 22 December 2025. Access Date: 26 December 2025. https://www3.nhk.or.jp/nhkworld/en/news/20251223_07

[969] Launch of Large-Scale Pilot Project of Government AI "GENNAI" targeting 180,000 Employees across all Ministries and Agencies, Digital Agency (Tokyo) 6 March 2026. Access Date: 31 March 2026. https://www.digital.go.jp/en/news/2d69c287-2897-46d8-a28f-ea5a1fc9bce9

On 24 June 2025, the Department for Business and Trade announced 12 SMEs as recipients of the 2025 Made in the UK, Sold to the World Awards, including firms utilizing AI in their products.[970] By recognizing and rewarding SMEs for utilizing AI to achieve exporting success, this action encourages the further adoption of AI in SMEs and makes UK-based businesses more competitive on a global scale.

On 1 July 2025, Technology Secretary Peter Kyle announced plans for the Regulatory Innovation Office to work with the Digital Regulation Cooperation Forum to reduce stringent regulations on AI adoption for SMEs in fintech and AI.[971] This will take place through the development of a unified digital library that provides a comprehensive guideline on regulations for innovators looking to adopt AI infrastructure in SMEs. This action will accelerate innovation and support SME growth and AI usage.

On 17 July 2025, the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology and UK Research and Innovation published the Compute Roadmap to increase domestic compute infrastructure, building on the government's Plan for Change, 10-year infrastructure strategy, and the Modern Industrial Strategy.[972] This action pledges to expand the UK'S AI Research Resource system twenty-fold over the next five years, supporting SME access to compute and AI.

On 16 September 2025, the UK and the United States of America agreed on the Tech Prosperity Deal, partnering to boost data centres and AI startups in the UK.[973] This agreement proposes the creation of a new AI Growth Zone in the North East, which will support the adoption of AI in SMEs by expanding their access to affordable compute infrastructure in order to compete in a competitive global market.

On 1 October 2025, the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology launched the Regional Tech Booster programme, which supports projects that help SMEs adopt AI through a series of investment events, a support scheme for start-ups, and accessible pathways for individuals that come from further education to entrepreneurship involving AI.[974] This programme directly supports the growth of SMEs and their adoption of AI by directing individuals to develop an understanding and interest in AI startups.

On 19 October 2025, Science and Technology Secretary Liz Kendall announced an investment of GBP20 million each for Greater Manchester, West Midlands and Glasgow City Region for AI-based SMEs as part of the Local Innovation Partnerships Fund and Plan for Change.[975] This action will support the creation of SMEs in AI and promote the development of Greater Manchester into an AI hub.

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[970] UK Government honours exceptional exporters with Made in the UK, Sold to the World Awards, Department for Business and Trade (London) 24 June 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.gov.uk/government/news/uk-government-honours-exceptional-exporters-with-made-in-the-uk-sold-to-the-world-awards

[971] Regulatory Innovation Office to help streamline regulation, helping UK's world-leading fintech sector, Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (London) 1 July 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.gov.uk/government/news/regulatory-innovation-office-to-help-streamline-regulation-helping-uks-world-leading-fintech-sector

[972] Engines of AI primed to accelerate new breakthroughs, economic growth, and transform the UK into an AI maker, Department for Science, Innovation and Technology, UK Research and Innovation (London) 17 July 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.gov.uk/government/news/engines-of-ai-primed-to-accelerate-new-breakthroughs-economic-growth-and-transform-the-uk-into-an-ai-maker

[973] US-UK pact will boost advances in drug discovery, create tens of thousands of jobs and transform lives, Prime Minister's Office (London) 16 September 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.gov.uk/government/news/us-uk-pact-will-boost-advances-in-drug-discovery-create-tens-of-thousands-of-jobs-and-transform-lives

[974] Local tech ready for take-off as 14 projects supporting businesses and jobs unveiled, Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (London) 1 October 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.gov.uk/government/news/local-tech-ready-for-take-off-as-14-projects-supporting-businesses-and-jobs-unveiled

[975] UK regions given extra £20 million science and tech cash boost as new investment kicks off landmark growth summit, Secretary of State for Science, Innovation and Technology (London) 19 October 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.gov.uk/government/news/uk-regions-given-extra-20m-science-and-tech-cash-boost-as-new-investment-kicks-off-landmark-growth-summit

On 21 October 2025, Technology Secretary Liz Kendall announced the AI Growth Lab which will cut red tape by piloting responsible AI to be adopted by people and businesses.[976] This action will seek to increase public trust in AI and support the adoption of AI in businesses.

On 29 October 2025, Skills England announced the AI Skills Framework, Adoption Pathway and Employer Checklist as part of the strategy to support AI adoption in various sectors, including for SMEs.[977] These tools will support SME AI adoption.

On 26 January 2026, the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology announced a GBP36 million injection into Cambridge University's DAWN supercomputer.[978] This investment is part of the government's AI Opportunities Action Plan, which promises GBP2 billion plus in funding to boost public compute infrastructure, including to the AI Research Resource. This action aims to help SMEs access supercomputing capabilities normally only available to big tech corporations, making AI accessible and affordable to the general public.

On 28 January 2026, the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology announced their expansion of free AI foundations training for all workers, including at least 2 million employees from SMEs.[979] This action aims to upskill millions of workers' proficiency with AI and will therefore support higher rates of AI adoption in SMEs.

On 16 March 2026, Work and Pensions Secretary Pat McFadden announced a major investment in youth employment of GBP1 billion to create 200,000 jobs for young people.[980] This investment includes the launch of an 18-month AI and automation practitioner apprenticeship, which aims to help workers and businesses integrate AI into their infrastructure by identifying the areas in which AI can be of use. This action intends to boost employment and productivity in AI-related fields to increase the competitiveness of domestic SMEs.

On 25 March 2026, the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology launched an AI Upskilling Challenge Fund and a new Healthcare Living Lab in Barnsley.[981] The GBP800,000 AI Upskilling Challenge Fund will support SMEs by providing workers with training in the usage of AI technology, which aims to increase competitiveness and efficiency in struggling industries run by older residents. The Healthcare Living Lab, created in partnership with Cisco, will improve hospital wait times and efficiency through AI usage and the implementation of AI tools and training by Cisco, SMEs

[976] New blueprint for AI regulation could speed up planning approvals, slash NHS waiting times, and drive growth and public trust, Secretary of State for Science, Innovation and Technology (London) 21 October 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.gov.uk/government/news/new-blueprint-for-ai-regulation-could-speed-up-planning-approvals-slash-nhs-waiting-times-and-drive-growth-and-public-trust
[977] Help for UK businesses to fill £400bn AI skills gap, Skills England (London) 29 October 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.gov.uk/government/news/help-for-uk-businesses-to-fill-400bn-ai-skills-gap
[978] Cambridge supercomputer set to get 6 times more powerful as government backs British AI innovation, Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (London) 26 January 2026. Access Date: 15 February 2026. https://www.gov.uk/government/news/cambridge-supercomputer-set-to-get-6-times-more-powerful-as-government-backs-british-ai-innovation
[979] Free AI training for all, as government and industry programme expands to provide 10 million workers with key AI skills by 2030, Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (London) 28 January 2026. Access Date: 15 February 2026. https://www.gov.uk/government/news/free-ai-training-for-all-as-government-and-industry-programme-expands-to-provide-10-million-workers-with-key-ai-skills-by-2030
[980] Major employment drive to help unlock 200,000 new jobs and apprenticeships for next generation, Department for Work and Pensions (London) 16 March 2026. Access Date: 29 March 2026. https://www.gov.uk/government/news/major-employment-drive-to-help-unlock-200000-new-jobs-and-apprenticeships-for-next-generation
[981] Faster care for patients, less admin for NHS staff and new AI skills for key industries as Barnsley Tech Town takes next big step, Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (London) 25 March 2026. Access Date: 29 March 2026. https://www.gov.uk/government/news/faster-care-for-patients-less-admin-for-nhs-staff-and-new-ai-skills-for-key-industries-as-barnsley-tech-town-takes-next-big-step

and the National Health Service. These programmes aim to increase the adoption of AI in SMEs across manufacturing and healthcare sectors to boost productivity and efficiency.

On 14 April 2026, Innovate UK launched the Frontier AI Discovery funding competition, making up to GBP2.5 million available to UK-registered organizations, including SMEs, to support feasibility studies for AI and foundation models.[982]

On 16 April 2026, the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology launched the GBP500 million Sovereign AI initiative, a national program designed to support domestic AI companies, including startups and SMEs, through a combination of direct investment, access to supercomputing infrastructure, and research and development funding.[983] The initiative provides selected firms with fully funded access to high-performance compute resources, including up to one million GPU hours, alongside financial backing, talent support through expedited visas, and assistance in scaling globally.

The United Kingdom has fully complied with its commitment to sustain investments in AI adoption programs for SMEs, having, including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure. The United Kingdom has demonstrated over five strong actions since the Kananaskis Summit, of which at least three have included supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure. Under the government's Plan for Change, including the Compute Roadmap, the United Kingdom seeks to build capacity in AI infrastructure, ease restrictions, improve accessibility, provide tools and drive growth in domestic AI adoption in various sectors for SMEs.

Thus, the United Kingdom receives a score of +1.

Analyst: Anson Hu

United States: 0

The United States has partially complied with its commitment to sustain investments in artificial intelligence (AI) adoption programs for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure.

On 23 July 2025, President Donald Trump released an Executive Order, Promoting the Export of the American Technology Stack, which establishes the AI Exports Program to promote the export of US full-stack AI packages.[984] This order includes coordinating with the Small Business Administration's Office of Investment and Innovation to channel investment into US small businesses to develop AI technology systems. This action will help US SMEs in becoming competitive on a global scale by promoting the export of American AI technology.

On 23 July 2025, the White House released America's AI Action Plan to accelerate US innovation in AI.[985] The strategy suggests bringing together stakeholders through the Department of Commerce National Telecommunications and Information Administration to support SME participation in

[982] Frontier AI Discovery, Government of the United Kingdom (London) 14 April 2026. Access Date: 26 April 2026. https://www.find-government-grants.service.gov.uk/grants/frontier-ai-discovery-1
[983] AI firms pioneering drug discovery, cheaper supercomputing and more get first backing through UK's Sovereign AI, Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (London) 16 April 2026. Access Date: 26 April 2026. https://www.gov.uk/government/news/ai-firms-pioneering-drug-discovery-cheaper-supercomputing-and-more-get-first-backing-through-uks-sovereign-ai
[984] Promoting The Export of the American AI Technology Stack, The White House (Washington D.C.) 23 July 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2025/07/promoting-the-export-of-the-american-ai-technology-stack/
[985] White House Unveils America's AI Action Plan, The White House (Washington D.C.) 23 July 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://www.whitehouse.gov/articles/2025/07/white-house-unveils-americas-ai-action-plan/

development of open-source and open-weight models and encourages SME access to large-scale computing power.

On 24 November 2025, the White House launched the "Genesis Mission," a program aiming to build an integrated AI platform that uses Federal scientific datasets to train AI scientific foundation models.[986] This increase in AI research and development will be used to help private-sector businesses like SMEs automate research workflows, improve data repositories for AI models and accelerate scientific breakthroughs. This will help SMEs integrate AI into their infrastructure and increase workforce productivity.

On 13 February 2026, the Department of Labor's Employment and Training Administration released an AI Literacy Framework to guide AI literacy efforts across education and workforce development systems, including SMEs.[987] This framework lays out five foundational content areas and seven delivery principles to strengthen AI capabilities across sectors and industries. This program supports the previously introduced AI Action Plan and America's Talent Strategy in providing SMEs with the foundation to support AI skill development among their employees.

On 20 February 2026, Director of the White House Office of Science and Technology Policy Michael Kratsios announced new initiatives designed to accelerate global integration of American AI exports at the India AI Impact Summit 2026.[988] These initiatives include sending the US Tech Corps to provide technical support to partner nations to better integrate AI into public services and opening a new fund at the World Bank to assist countries in overcoming financial barriers to adopting AI in SMEs, education and healthcare. This program is primarily aimed to support the adoption of American AI in SMEs located in developing countries, with the intent to boost their economies and promote the export of American AI products.

On 20 March 2026, the White House released a National Policy Framework for Artificial Intelligence, which outlines a federal approach to support AI development and deployment across the US economy.[989] The framework highlights the role of small businesses and calls for Congress to provide grants, tax incentives and technical assistance to support AI adoption, alongside investments in data infrastructure and energy capacity. While these measures remain in the recommendation phase, they demonstrate intent to strengthen SME participation in AI-driven growth by reducing barriers and expanding access to resources.

The United States has partially complied with its commitment to sustain investments in AI adoption programs for SMEs, including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure. The United States has taken some action since the Kananaskis Summit to sustain AI innovation through targeted investments that provide funding for SMEs developing AI technologies and support for open-access infrastructure for SMEs. However, the US actions remain in the early implementation phase and do not directly address large-scale, sustained AI adoption among SMEs.

Thus, the United States receives a score of 0.

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[986] Launching The Genesis Mission, The White House (Washington D.C.) 24 November 2025. Access Date: 11 December 2025. https://www.whitehouse.gov/presidential-actions/2025/11/launching-the-genesis-mission/

[987] US Department of Labor releases AI literacy framework providing foundational content areas, delivery principles to guide nationwide efforts, US Department of Labor (Washington D.C.) 13 February 2026. Access Date: 14 February 2026. https://www.dol.gov/newsroom/releases/eta/eta20260213

[988] US Promotes AI Adoption, Sovereignty, and Exports at India AI Impact Summit, The White House (Washington D.C.) 20 https://www.whitehouse.gov/articles/2026/02/u-s-promotes-ai-adoption-sovereignty-and-exports-at-india-ai-impact-summit/

[989] A National Policy Framework for AI, The White House (Washington D.C.) 20 March 2026. Access Date: 31 March 2025. https://www.whitehouse.gov/wp-content/uploads/2026/03/03.20.26-National-Policy-Framework-for-Artificial-Intelligence-Legislative-Recommendations.pdf

Analyst: Jeanne Brownewell

European Union: +1

The European Union has fully complied with its commitment to sustain investments in artificial intelligence (AI) adoption programs for small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs), including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure.

On 17 July 2025, the European Commission launched a call for various stakeholders across civil society to partake in the AI Act Advisory Forum, a panel dedicated to soliciting expertise, advice and input on strategies to implement AI responsibly and effectively from stakeholders involved in sectors such as SMEs and start-ups.[990] This forum will ensure a balanced representation of stakeholders' interests and provide a platform for SMEs to voice concerns, queries, and suggestions for further support to integrate AI into their businesses.

On 8 October 2025, the European Commission launched the Apply AI Strategy, a strategy designed to accelerate AI adoption across Europe's strategic sectors.[991] This will be done through sector-specific investment initiatives, an implementation of an AI first policy where AI must be considered as a potential solution whenever possible, and a 'buy European' approach where sectors are encouraged to use European-based open source AI solutions. This will support the ability of SMEs to implement and scale AI solutions in their organizations and promote the usage of AI technology created by SMEs to the public.

On 8 October 2025, the European Commission launched the AI in Science strategy, which uses a virtual institute named Resource for AI Science in Europe (RAISE) to pool and coordinate AI resources to support AI research and development.[992] Funds include EUR600 million in funding from Horizon Europe to support startup access to computational power. This strategy will enable SMEs to more easily access and afford funding to develop AI infrastructure.

On 8 October 2025, the European Commission launched the AI Act Service Desk and Single Information Platform, a centralized hub designed to provide all relevant information on the EU AI Act to support SMEs in understanding and complying with its regulations.[993] The single information platform includes a Compliance Checker, an AI Act Explorer, and an AI Act Service Desk to clarify regulatory requirements and offer tailored guidance. This initiative will enable SMEs to more easily navigate AI regulations and integrate AI solutions into their operations.

On 10 October 2025, the European Commission announced their intention to build six new AI Factories in the Czech Republic, Lithuania, the Netherlands, Romania, Spain, and Poland.[994] Factories will provide AI-optimized supercomputers and technical support to startups and SMEs, enabling SMEs to more easily adopt and deploy AI into their solutions.

[990] European Commission launches call for applications to join AI Act Advisory Forum, European Commission (Brussels) 17 July 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/funding/european-commission-launches-call-applications-join-ai-act-advisory-forum

[991] Apply AI Strategy, European Commission (Brussels) 8 October 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/policies/apply-ai

[992] Keeping European industry and science at the forefront of AI, European Commission (Brussels) 8 October 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://commission.europa.eu/news-and-media/news/keeping-european-industry-and-science-forefront-ai-2025-10-08_en

[993] Commission launches AI Act Service Desk and Single Information Platform to support AI Act implementation, European Commission (Brussels) 8 October 2025. Access Date: 1 December 2025. https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/news/commission-launches-ai-act-service-desk-and-single-information-platform-support-ai-act

[994] EU expands network of AI Factories, strengthening its 'AI Continent' ambition, European Commission (Brussels) 10 October 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/news/eu-expands-network-ai-factories-strengthening-its-ai-continent-ambition

On 21 October 2025, the European Commission announced the seventh AI Pact webinar on AI Innovation for SMEs and startups, which will explain to SMEs and startups how to navigate regulatory compliance proposed by the EU AI Act.[995] This will reduce barriers to AI innovation across the EU, enable them to compete with the global AI industry, and reduce administrative and financial barriers for SMEs.

On 19 November 2025, the European Commission announced the launch of the European Data Union Strategy, which is one of three parts of the European Commission's Digital Package to help EU businesses affordably and effectively integrate high-quality AI into their infrastructures.[996] The Data Union Strategy aims to increase the availability of cheap and high-quality data sets to train AI tools in SMEs, streamline data regulations to give businesses legal certainty and lessen compliance costs, and safeguard the EU's data sovereignty to increase the global competitiveness of its data industry. This will allow SMEs to benefit from easier access to high-quality data sets, reducing work and time spent on correcting errors and problems that arise from lower-quality sets.

On 28 November 2025, the European Commission further outlined the actions it would take as part of the Apply AI Strategy to accelerate AI adoption in the manufacturing, engineering, and construction sectors.[997] This includes supporting the development of AI manufacturing models, funding the development of "Acceleration Pipelines" supporting the transition of AI from research to industry deployment, and expanding the Testing and Experimentation Facilities (TEF), allowing SMEs to trial, validate, and certify AI-enabled technologies. These actions will reduce technical and operational barriers to AI adoption, helping SMEs in these key sectors to enhance their productivity and competitiveness.

On 21 January 2026, the European Economic and Social Committee (EESC) called for rapid and concrete measures to accelerate AI commercialization for SMEs and scale-ups in the single market, including access to funding, skills investment and regulatory clarity. This action endorses the European Commission's Apply AI Strategy and moves away from research and development to everyday use in business, noting that AI deployment strategies must balance economic competitiveness with social and workforce protections.[998] This action demonstrates the EU's willingness to provide measures of protection and support to encourage the growth of AI adoption in SMEs.

On 27 March 2026, the European Commission advanced the Apply AI Strategy, a comprehensive policy framework aimed at boosting AI adoption and innovation across the European Union, particularly among SMEs.[999] The strategy introduces sector-specific measures to accelerate AI deployment across key industries, strengthens access to AI infrastructure and support systems through initiatives such as European Digital Innovation Hubs, AI Factories, and regulatory sandboxes, and promotes the development of an AI-ready workforce. It also establishes new governance mechanisms, including the Apply AI Alliance and AI Observatory, to coordinate stakeholders and monitor progress.

[995] Seventh AI Pact webinar on AI Innovation for SMEs and startups, European Commission (Brussels) 21 October 2025. Access Date: 31 October 2025. https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/events/seventh-ai-pact-webinar-ai-innovation-smes-and-startups

[996] European Data Union Strategy, European Commission (Brussels) 19 November 2025. Access Date: 10 December 2025. https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/policies/data-union

[997] AI for Manufacturing, Engineering and Construction: Commission Launches Flagship Actions under the Apply AI Strategy, European Commission (Brussels) 28 November 2025. Access Date: 1 December 2025. https://futurium.ec.europa.eu/en/apply-ai-alliance/news/ai-manufacturing-engineering-and-construction-commission-launches-flagship-actions-under-apply-ai

[998] Apply AI Strategy, European Economic and Social Committee (Brussels) 21 January 2026. Access Date: 14 February 2026. https://www.eesc.europa.eu/en/news-media/press-summaries/apply-ai-strategy

[999] Apply AI Strategy, European Economic and Social Committee (Brussels) 27 March 2026. Access Date: 22 April 2026. https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/policies/apply-ai

On 9 April 2025, the European Commission published the AI Continent Action Plan, outlining a comprehensive strategy to position the European Union as a global leader in AI.[1000] The plan sets out coordinated actions across key areas including the expansion of AI computing infrastructure through the development of AI Factories and Gigafactories, increased investment in cloud and data centre capacity, and the implementation of a Data Union Strategy to improve access to high-quality data for businesses. It also includes measures to support AI adoption among enterprises and public administrations, strengthen workforce skills through initiatives such as the AI Skills Academy and Digital Innovation Hubs, and provide regulatory support and guidance through the implementation of the AI Act.

The EU has fully complied with its commitment to promoting AI adoption by SMEs., including supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure. The EU has taken more than five strong actions to provide ongoing funding, talent development resources, and coordination mechanisms for SMEs to develop and implement AI solutions across sectors through the Apply AI and AI in Science Strategies, with at least three actions directly supporting access to compute and digital infrastructure. The EU has taken steps to provide accessible information on AI rules and regulations through the AI Act Advisory Forum, and AI Act Service Desk and Single Information Platform. Finally, the EU demonstrates its commitment to providing access to high-quality compute and digital infrastructure through the European Data Union Strategy, the EESC's strategy to accelerate AI for SMEs and RAISE virtual institute and AI Factories. These actions facilitate the adoption of AI in SMEs by making them more accessible and reliable.

Thus, the EU receives a score of +1.

Analyst: Jeanne Brownewell

[1000] AI Continent Action Plan, European Union (Brussels) 9 April 2026. Access Date: 24 April 2026. https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/ai-continent-action-plan